

the panic began in earnest. Be sure that I welcomed him. If any man possessed power to look into the future, that man was Mr. Stillman. His mind was ceaselessly trying to fit together the things that he knew, so as to give him a better understanding of what was coming. It was not precisely like having a crystal ball to have access to Mr. Stillman's intelligence, but it was, I think, the next thing to it. Often the proposal that Mr. Stillman uttered quietly was the thing that Mr. Morgan executed; but Mr. Stillman was above the struggle, rather than in it.

Banking is not a field for weaklings. . . .

One of the early features of the panic had been the discrediting of individuals who had come to occupy important positions in the banking structure. Among them were Charles W. Morse, Edward R. Thomas, and Orlando F. Thomas. These men who had acquired important banking interests by daring operations were forced to retire from all banking positions. Public opinion was aroused against Morse in particular, and his resignations created vacancies on the boards of a number of banks. In some cases entire boards of directors were forced out of office. There was, as a result, just that much more work to be done by those experienced bankers in whom confidence continued.

I remember one incident in a small, private room of one of the up-town banks. It was quite late at night. Seven or eight of us who represented the strongest institutions in the city had gathered to determine if we would be justified in using some of the doubly-precious cash of our banks to enable a weaker one to open its doors on the following morning. Mr. Morgan had come to this meeting.

Mr. Morgan's utterances usually came with a force that suggested his words were literally fired from the remarkable, cannon-like cigars that he smoked habitually. He was a con-